

HOUSE RESOLUTION 176

By Shaw

A RESOLUTION to commend Kennedy Havard for exemplary service as a legislative intern.

WHEREAS, each legislative session, the members of this legislative body are pleased to recognize certain persons who have committed themselves, through their adroit service, to the betterment of the legislative process; and

WHEREAS, Kennedy Havard is one such individual, who has distinguished herself in her role as a legislative intern for Representative Johnny Shaw; Ms. Havard's work has resulted in innumerable benefits for the legislators she assisted and the General Assembly as a whole; and

WHEREAS, a native of Chicago, Illinois, Kennedy Havard is the daughter of Shiquesha Downey and Tyrone Downey and was instilled with the passion for leadership, excellence, and public service; and

WHEREAS, throughout high school, Ms. Havard was actively involved in student government, served as cheer captain, and was a proud member of the Honor Society, all of which helped shape her confidence, discipline, and dedication to serving others; and

WHEREAS, a senior at Tennessee State University (TSU), where she is highly regarded by her peers, Kennedy Havard has achieved academic success while pursuing a degree in political science and urban studies; she has a strong interest in education policy, social justice, and community development; and

WHEREAS, during her collegiate career, Ms. Havard has gained experience working in educational and childcare settings, further strengthening her passion for youth development and learning; she currently serves as a Resident Assistant in Wilson Hall, where she mentors and supports first-year students as they transition into college life; and

WHEREAS, Kennedy Havard's leadership extends beyond the residence hall as she serves as the Undergraduate Member-at-Large for Zeta Phi Beta Sorority, Inc., for the State of Tennessee, as well as a university ambassador; she is a member of Phi Alpha Delta Law Fraternity and participates in the OSA NPHC branch; and

WHEREAS, following graduation, Ms. Havard plans to continue her education at TSU and pursue a master's degree in education with a concentration in instructional leadership, further demonstrating her commitment to serving the public and advocating for equitable opportunities for all students; and

WHEREAS, eager to familiarize herself with the characteristics and complexities of Tennessee State government and to further her studies, Kennedy Havard brought her many abilities and singular expertise to Capitol Hill for the 2026 session of the One Hundred Fourteenth General Assembly; and

WHEREAS, throughout the 2026 legislative session, Ms. Havard has surpassed all criteria that define a devoted and conscientious legislative intern; and

WHEREAS, Kennedy Havard has performed her many duties with extraordinary insight and rare decorum; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we commend Kennedy Havard for outstanding service as a legislative intern for Representative Johnny Shaw and extend to her our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.